

First Read

China Industrials

Shipping supply chain weekly: trade flows, freight and Hormuz updates (week 24)

Key highlights from high-frequency data

We compile weekly data from UBS Evidence Lab, the Ministry of Transport, UBS Evidence Lab and other third-party data providers to track the latest trade flows across shipping, shipbuilding and ports.

Hormuz reopen may result in recovery of VLCC average earnings

Oil and tanker stocks moved reacted positively to the US-Iran peace agreement, with sentiment supported by the announced reopening of the Strait of Hormuz. While daily vessel transits through the Strait of Hormuz remained constrained in early June. VLCC average earnings from Middle East/West Africa to China remained flattish while earnings from US Gulf to China remained stable last week, with average earnings below US\$100k/day.

Container shipping volume keep rising

Container throughput at key ports in China declined 1% WoW while increasing 5% YoY last week. Amid a pick-up in shipping demand, main lane freight rates saw further gains: overall SCFI freight rates increased by 9% WoW last week (+43% YoY), with Shanghai-Europe +18% WoW and Transpacific +10-12% WoW; Port of LA imports were up 7% YoY in week 24 and estimated to grow ~7% YoY in week 25. Intra-Asia containership chartering index recovered by 0.5% WoW last week. Based on our Maritime Destination Monitor ([\(> Access Dataset\)](#)), the container shipping volume in Asia-US route showed strong YoY growth since May.

BDI & earnings of bulker and new build price remained elevated

The bulker market softened last week, with BDI down 10% WoW and average earnings of capesize bulker down 18% WoW, but BDI has still recorded a 61% rally YTD. The shipbuilding newbuild price index remained flattish WoW last week.

Equities

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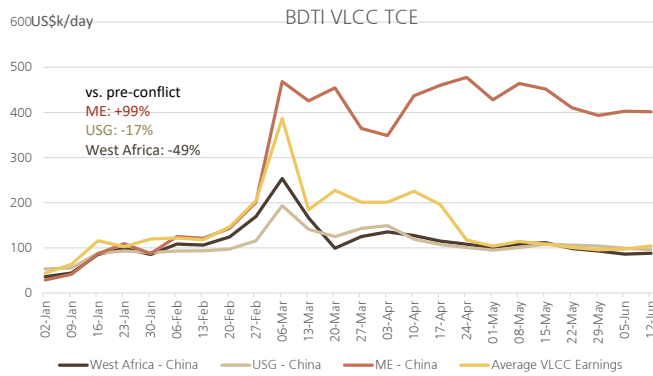
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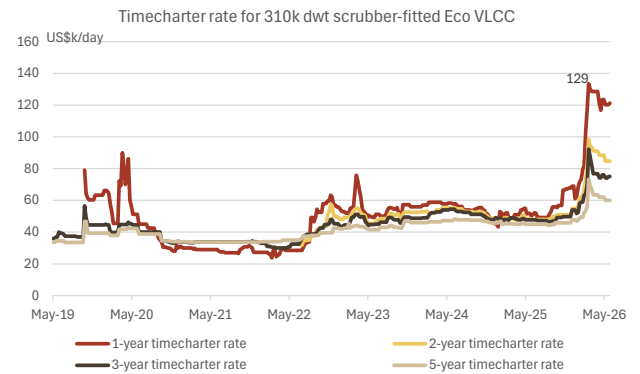
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Figure 1: Middle East/US Gulf/West Africa-China VLCC TCE +99%/-17%/-49% vs. pre-conflict level



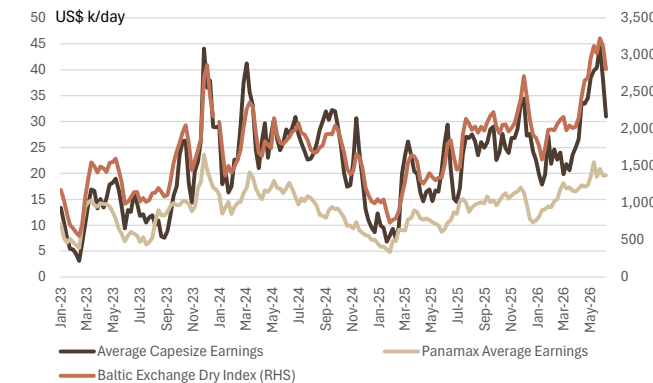
Source: Clarksons, data as of 12 June

Figure 2: VLCC 1 year charter rate remained stable



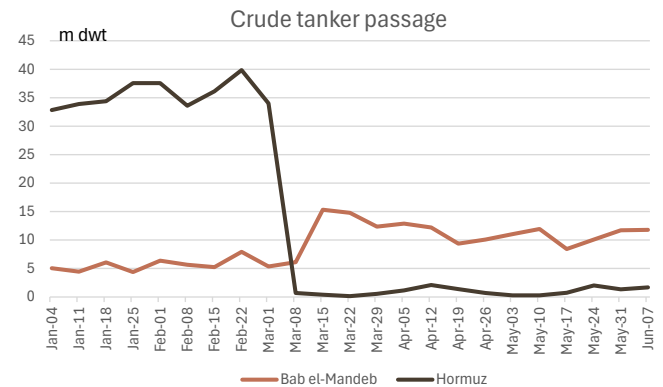
Source: Clarksons, data as of 12 June

Figure 3: Average earnings of Capesize dropped by 18% WoW last week



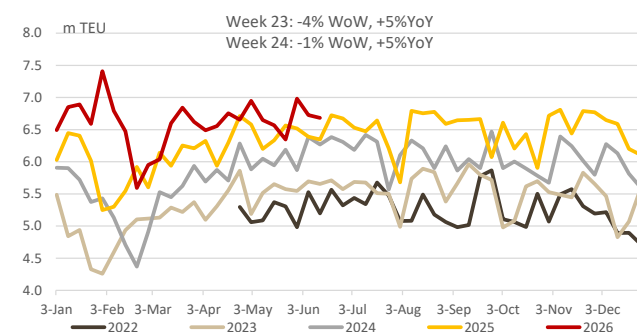
Source: Clarksons, data as of 12 June

Figure 4: Crude tanker passage at Hormuz remained 95% below pre-conflict level



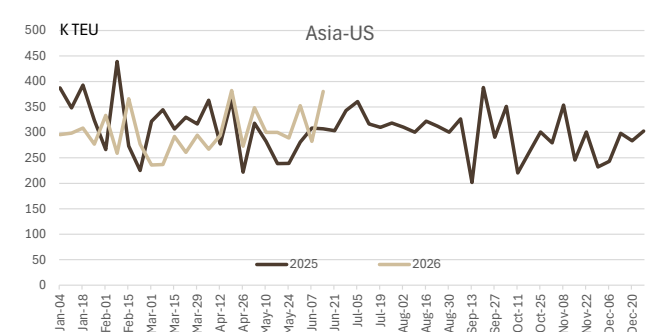
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

Figure 5: Container throughput at China's key ports -4% WoW, 5% YoY last week



Source: Ministry of Transport

Figure 6: Container volume new in transit from Asia to US has been showing a front loading pattern



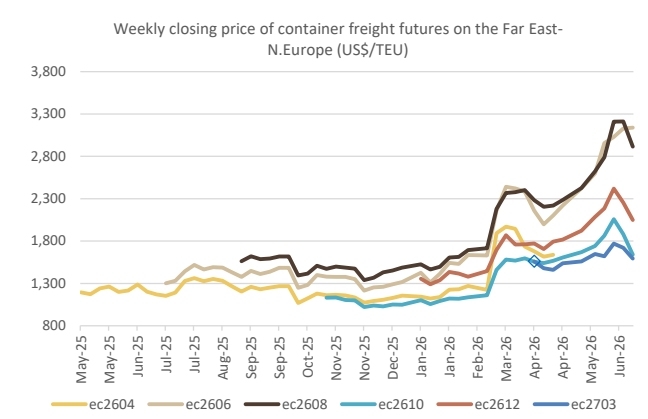
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

Figure 7: SCFI +9% WoW and +43% YoY

WoW/YoY	SCFI	CCFI	SCFI Europe	SCFI W/C US	SCFI E/C US	NCFI Thailand&Vietnam
2026-05-08	2%/45%	1%/16%	5%/37%	4%/20%	3%/14%	2%/18%
2026-05-15	10%/45%	0%/16%	14%/57%	10%/1%	11%/4%	6%/29%
2026-05-22	4%/40%	3%/19%	5%/45%	1%/-4%	2%/1%	1%/15%
2026-05-29	16%/24%	4%/22%	30%/56%	31%/-20%	24%/-15%	-1%/10%
2026-06-05	6%/22%	3%/22%	5%/56%	10%/-19%	8%/-17%	-5%/10%
2026-06-12	9%/43%	5%/19%	18%/66%	12%/25%	10%/-6%	-5%/11%

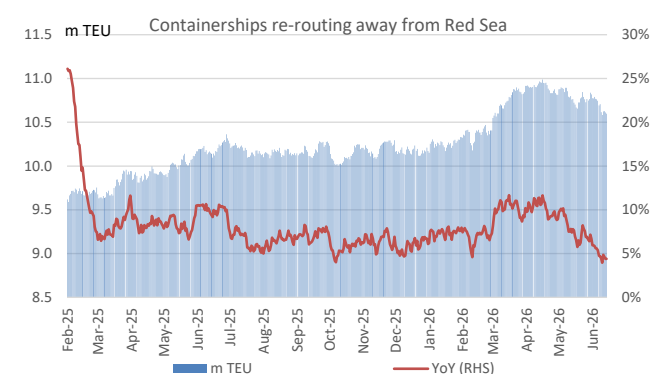
Source: Shanghai Shipping Exchange, Clarksons, data as of 12 June 2026

Figure 8: Container freight futures on Far East-Northern Europe fall back after US-Iran peace deal



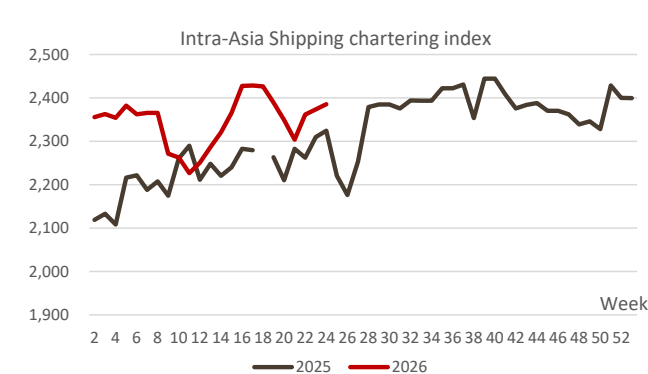
Source: Shanghai Futures Exchange

Figure 9: Container ships re-routing away from Red Sea still at high levels (+4-5% YoY)



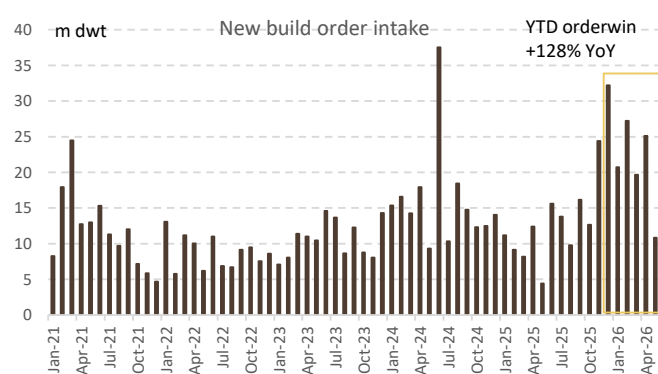
Source: Clarksons; Note: data as of 12 June 2026

Figure 10: Intra-Asia chartering index recovered WoW last week



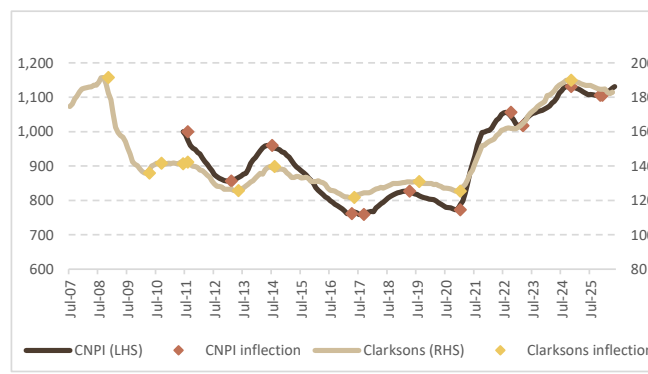
Source: Company data

Figure 11: Strong VLCC demand drives up YTD strong global shipbuilding demand



Source: Clarksons

Figure 12: Both Clarksons and CNPI indicate new build price continue to increase



Source: Clarksons, CNPI, as of 14 June 2026

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Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 31 March 2026.

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